

The benchmark for personalisation

Your phone is extremely personal. So much that simple glances from strangers towards your phone trigger alarms within your psyche. With such a personal device, can you really push the envelope and make it even more personal? The simple answer is yes. While modular smartphones have certainly failed to make a dent in the smartphone market, the custom ROM scene is a different picture altogether. So your hardware may certainly remain the same but the software, which is essentially what breathes life into the carefully constructed pile of silicon, can certainly be customised to suit your whims.

A mere glance at the XDA forums should tell you how bustling the custom ROM scene is. Once a new phone is launched, it hardly takes a few hours before enthusiastic developers begin ripping into the stock ROM and start making changes. Some of the most popular smartphones within the custom ROM circuit are the devices launched by OnePlus which started off with the mantra of “Never Settle”. These OnePlus devices since the OnePlus One, up until the recently launched OnePlus 6 have all featured the very best hardware for Android to run on. These flagship devices provide a wide scope for custom ROM development as evidenced by the massive activity on the forum threads for these devices. Which is exactly why we’ve decided to pick these OnePlus devices for our FastTrack.

Customising an Android ROM is no easy task and the process is more or less similar across the breadth of Android smartphones. The problems arise when each manufacturer uses a different piece of hardware, each hardware that’s changed requires a certain modification to be made. And it is these modified files which are a pain to find when creating your own